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50 Essential Advanced Vocab for Picture Description

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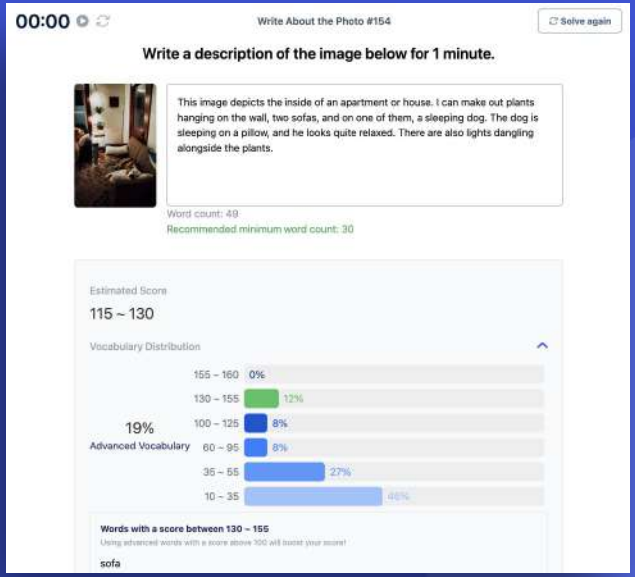
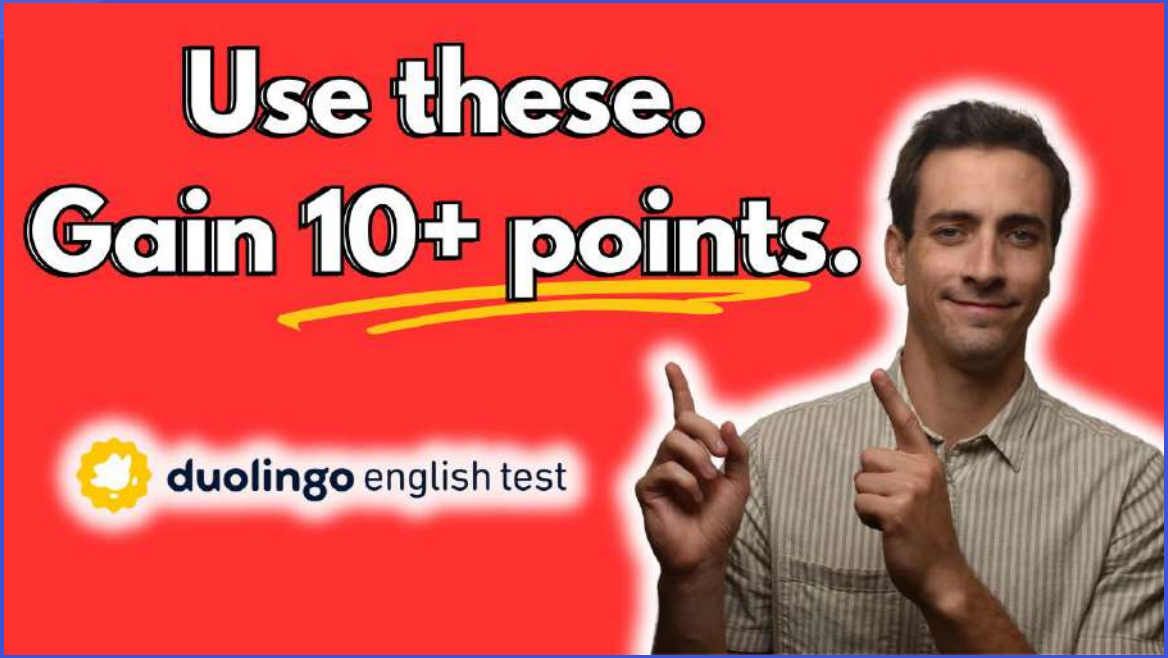


We have a full video lesson that teaches you how to use all of this vocabulary! Watch it here.



Wide shot

A photo that captures a large area

*This image is a **wide shot** of a beach.*

Close up

A photo that focuses on a small detail or object

*This image is a **close up** of someone pouring steamed milk into a mug of coffee.*

Black and white

No color

*This is a **black and white** image of two dolphins leaping out of the sea.*

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Focal point

The focus on the image

*The **focal point** of the image is a bright red sign.*

Positioned

Where something is placed in the image

*A skyscraper is **positioned** in the middle of the image.*

*A church is **positioned** on the lefthand side of the photo.*

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In the background

Behind the main subject

***In the background**, we can see many white houses.*

***Positioned in the background**, we can see many white houses.*

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In the foreground

In front, closest to the viewer

***In the foreground**, we can see a woman with blond hair, a black shirt, and white pants.*

***The focal point of the image, in the foreground**, is a woman with blond hair, a black shirt, and white pants.*

Dominating the scene

Taking up most of the space or attention

*In this image, a tall tree is **dominating the scene**.*

*In this image, a tall tree is **dominating the scene in the foreground.***

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I can make out

I can see, but not very clearly

*In this image, **I can make out** a person standing in the middle of a field.*

I get the impression that

It seems like

I get the impression that *the two children in this image are siblings.*

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In the process of

Doing

*This image depicts two people **in the process of** cooking.*

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Depicts

Shows or represents

*This image **depicts** a city street on a rainy day.*

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Partially visible

Only part of it can be seen

*This image depicts a red building that is **partially visible**.*

Architectural style

The design of a building

This building has a futuristic ***architectural style****.*

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Futuristic

Looks modern and from the future

*This building has a **futuristic** architectural style.*

Classical

Inspired by old, elegant styles

*This building has a **classical** architectural style.*

Functional

Simple and useful

*This building has a **functional** architectural style.*

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Plain

No decoration

*This building has a **plain** architectural style.*

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Ornate

Full of details and decorations

*This building has an **ornate** architectural style.*

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Brutalist

A rough, concrete-heavy style

*This building has a **brutalist** architectural style.*

*This building has a **brutalist, functional** architectural style.*

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Brick

*This building is made of **brick**.*

*This **brick** building has a **classical** architectural style.*

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Glass

*This building is made of **glass**.*

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Steel

*This building is made of **glass** and **steel**.*

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Skyscraper

A very tall building

*This **skyscraper** is made of **glass** and **steel**.*

Concrete

This skyscraper is made of ***concrete.***

This skyscraper is made of ***concrete*** *and has a brutalist, functional architectural style.*

Structure

A general word for a building or construction

*This image depicts a young woman sitting on a blue and orange **structure** made of steel.*

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Spacious

Big with lots of room

*This image depicts a **spacious** room with large windows.*

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Light-filled

Bright with natural light

*This image depicts a **light-filled, spacious** room with large windows.*

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Airy

Open

*This image depicts an **airy, light-filled, spacious** room with large windows.*

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Pitched

A roof at an angle

*This house has a **pitched** roof.*

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Flat

A roof that is not at an angle

*This house has a **flat** roof.*

Overcast

Completely covered with gray clouds

*The sky in this image is **overcast**.*

Partially cloudy

Some clouds, but some blue sky too

*The sky in this image is **partially cloudy**.*

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Cloudless

No clouds, only clear sky

*The sky in this image is **cloudless**.*

Dreary

Gray, dull, and a little sad

The weather in this photo is ***dreary.***

Stormy

With strong wind, rain, or thunder

The weather in this photo is ***stormy.***

Chilly

Cold

*The weather in this photo is **chilly.***

Agreeable

Nice and comfortable

The weather in this photo is ***agreeable.***

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Balmy

Warm and pleasant

*The weather in this photo is **balmy.***

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Atmosphere

The mood or feeling of a place

*The **atmosphere** of this photo is peaceful.*

Peaceful

Quiet and calm

The atmosphere of this photo is ***peaceful****.*

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Hectic

Busy and chaotic

The atmosphere of this photo is ***hectic.***

Solemn

Serious and respectful

The atmosphere of this photo is ***solemn****.*

Cozy

Warm, small, and comfortable

The atmosphere of this photo is ***cozy****.*

Eerie

Spooky or mysterious

The atmosphere of this photo is ***eerie****.*

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Tense

Uncomfortable or stressful

The atmosphere of this photo is ***tense***.

Light

Mixed with white

*This image depicts a **light** pink home next to a **light** blue home.*

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Dark

Mixed with black

*This image depicts a **dark** green backpack.*

Bright

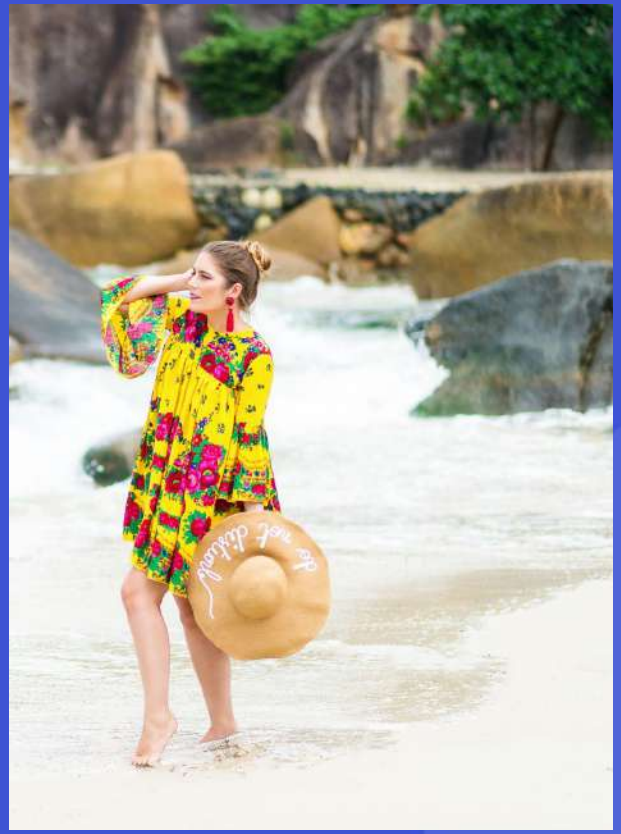
Strong and eye-catching

*This image depicts a **bright** yellow car.*

Vivid

Very strong or bright

*This image depicts a woman wearing a dress with **vivid** yellow, pink, and green.*



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